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CRISIS

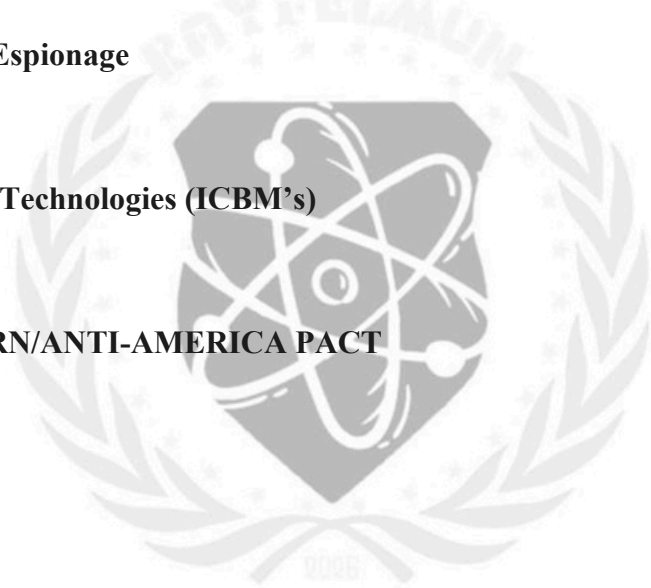
Rayfelmun



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and Espionages*

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Dear Delegates,

Welcome to RAYFELMUN'26 and welcome to this committee, at a critical juncture for the world. The international environment we face today is shaped not only by political disagreements, but also by the shadow of nuclear weapons and the uncertainties created by intelligence wars. We live in an era of increasingly fragile balances of power, weakening trust between states, and deepening global polarization.

In this crisis committee, you will serve not only as representatives of your countries, but also as decision-makers who can change the course of history. Your decisions could prevent wars or ignite new conflicts. You will forge alliances, conduct negotiations, encounter classified information, and have to make strategic choices in the face of rapidly changing events.

Remember that in times of crisis, the greatest threats are not only weapons; they are miscalculations, communication breakdowns, and mutual distrust. Therefore, the diplomacy, leadership, and strategic thinking skills you will demonstrate throughout this committee will be of paramount importance.

The decisions you make here today can affect the future not only of the states you represent, but of the entire world. I believe you will act with this sense of responsibility, and I wish you a successful and memorable committee process.

You can contact me via my email.

Yours Faithfully,

Defne YAMAN

Head of Academy

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2. Letter From The Under Secretary

General Dear Delegates,

It is an honour for me to welcome you all to the **Joint Crisis Committee of RAYFELMUN'26**. I believe this committee that is prepared with our respectful team members' efforts will show you our past from many different angles.

In this committee we will look into many **“What if?”s of the Cold War** and see what could have happened in an alternate scenario. This age is the age of **agents, schemes and ICBM's**. Maybe West and East will collide and many will suffer, maybe peace will be the solution.

As the crisis team our efforts are only for you to have a great MUN experience. I hope with all my heart this committee exceeds my expectations and becomes interesting at least.

Eren Kınış
Under Secretary
General



3. History (Real Life)

In the paper, the Cold War started with the Truman Doctrine, which was announced by the USA in 1947. Doctrine determined the USA's foreign policy and was created to oppose the Soviet Bloc and USSR. In other name it was a doctrine for the "containment" of Communism. After that, important events can be chronologically listed as follows:

- The USA launched the Marshall Plan in 1948 for the economic recovery of Western Europe. This also resulted in the establishment of NATO in 1949.
- The USSR installed satellite governments in Eastern Europe and North Korea by 1949. This also resulted in Germany's separation into West and East, famously known as the "Iron Curtain".
- The Korean War happened (1950-1953) and ended in a stalemate.
- USA supported First World anti-communist and right-wing dictatorships and uprisings. On the other hand USSR supported left-wing dictatorships in second-world and newly formed countries -many of which were old colonies-. This turned those newly formed countries into battlefields.
- The Cuban Revolution: The first communist regime was formed in the Western Hemisphere in 1959 by the USSR.

- Cuban Missile Crisis (1962): Soviet missiles in Cuba and USA missiles in Europe, it was the closest time that the world has ever come to the edge of nuclear war in the Cold War.

- Vietnam War (1955-1975): The US was defeated.

Some Other Important Events: Soviet-China relations broke down in 1961 and they came to the brink of war. Then in 1972 the US initiated diplomatic contacts with China and a period of détente started between the US, USSR, and China. Countries signed treaties that limited their nuclear arsenals. But peace was still far. With the toppling of US-funded governments in Iran and Nicaragua in 1979, the Soviet-Afghan War raised tensions. When Mikhail Gorbachev became the new leader of the USSR and the political freedom expanded, it led to the revolutions of 1989, and by 1991, the Eastern Bloc and USSR collapsed. This marked the end of the Cold War.

4. Spying and Espionage

Through the Cold War espionage had a lot of importance for both sides. Technological advances were used by both sides to the utmost. USA, USSR and UK's foreign espionage agencies played very important roles in the Cold War.

Central Intelligence Agency (CIA): USA's intelligence agency which operated many important missions against Eastern Bloc. The CIA developed concealment devices such as suicide glasses (containing a hidden cyanide pellet), poison-tipped pins, and hollowed-out everyday objects (like coins, shoes, and pipes) to smuggle microfilm or conceal weapons.

Komitet Gosudarstvennoy Bezopasnosti (KGB): USSR's Espionage and intelligence agency.

GRU and Stasi are two other agencies that are important for general operations and East Germany.

Secret Intelligence Service (MI6): UK's agency for secret intelligence gathering. In other name it is the "secret sibling" of MI5.

Other Important Terms:

Dead Drops: Secret locations used by case officers and agents to exchange documents, money, or equipment without ever meeting in person.

Venona Project: A highly secretive long-term U.S. counterintelligence program that succeeded in decrypting a significant number of Soviet diplomatic and intelligence messages.

Disinformation: Government-sponsored campaigns designed to spread false information, manipulate public opinion, and discredit political enemies in foreign nations.

Proxy Conflicts: Agencies on both sides heavily funded, armed, and trained proxy factions in global theaters like Korea, Vietnam, and Latin America.

5. New Missile Technologies (ICBMs)

Intercontinental Ballistic Missiles are long-range weapons capable of bringing nuclear warheads and mass destruction with them. These weapons can travel across continents in less than 30 minutes.

The world's first ICBM was the Soviet R-7 Semyorka which was tested in 1957. US Atlas series used cryogenic fuels -which had a dangerous and time-consuming fueling process.- but later on transitioned to the Minuteman series with solid fuels, allowing missiles to be kept in constant readiness. Later in the Cold War these missiles were also improved with MIRVs (Multiple Independently Targetable Reentry Vehicles) and this made them able to shoot 10 different targets at the same time.

Silo fields and mobile launchers were introduced to the world in this era. Both the USSR and the USA built fortified missile silos. The Soviets also discovered TELs (Transporter Erector Launchers) in mid 1980s Soviets already developed rail-mobile SS-24's but testing and production of road-mobile SS-25's took place in the late 80s.

Because an ICBM launched from anywhere in Eurasia took about 15 to 20 minutes to reach North America, new radar systems and missile defence systems were introduced to the world during the Cold War.

6. NATO/PTO

•USA

— **Army: 1,800,000 active personnel**

—**GDP: \$5,368,000,000,000**

—**Population:231.664.000**

—**Nuclear War Heads: 24.104**

John F. Kennedy, the Democratic Party candidate who won the 1961 elections, implemented new measures such as offering social rights to Black people and women, supporting the poor with a welfare state approach, and new economic reforms in the style of Lincoln. Although the Bay of Pigs Operation ended in great disappointment, he pursued a successful policy during the Cuban Missile Crisis, and a significant achievement was gained through mutual withdrawal. The activities of organizations such as the CIA and AZC were restricted, and Israel's development of nuclear weapons was prevented. With all these developments, Kennedy, having also secured the support of the public, became the overwhelming favorite of the 1965 elections. However, three months before the election, he was assassinated in Utah. It is alleged that the mafia, the Ku Klux Klan, MOSSAD, the CIA, and certain communists operating in America had a hand in the assassination. The new candidate and president for both the remaining few months in office and the elections became Lyndon B. Johnson. Johnson also won the elections.

During the Johnson era, the United States sent troops to Vietnam by the joint decision of Congress and the White House. However, in 1968, a disagreement arose within the army

over whether or not to enter a village in Vietnam. As a result of the disagreement, the order within the U.S. army broke down, and some of the civilians in the village were massacred. This incident received great coverage in the foreign press and seriously damaged the image of the United States. The U.S. is forced to withdraw from Vietnam.

Following the debacle in Vietnam, purges and a cleanup were initiated within the army. After this event, the Democrats lost the election to Republican candidate Richard Nixon. Following the negative developments, internal instability, and the aftermath, the U.S. decides to reassess its foreign policies. Shortly after, internal turmoil breaks out due to the Watergate Scandal. Nixon resigned and handed over the office to Vice President Gerald Ford. After completing the term, Gerald Ford ran as a candidate in the elections but lost to Democratic candidate Jimmy Carter.

During the Carter era, army restructuring continued. The government's trust in the army has been seriously shaken. In the middle of the Carter era, the Soviets invaded Afghanistan. Due to distrust of the army, the U.S. hesitated to intervene militarily in this situation, which caused the Soviets to gain a significant advantage. With Ronald Reagan's victory in the 1981 elections, the Republican Party returned to power.

The disorder in the army is somewhat remedied, but neither the army's respect for the government nor the government's trust in the army is what it once was. Despite these shortcomings, in terms of military, the U.S. possesses one of the two most powerful armies in the world, along with the Soviets. In foreign policy, it has largely regained its image as a 'good actor.'

•United Kingdom

— **Army: 320,000 active personnel**

— **GDP: \$591,000,000,000**

— **Population: 56.300.000**

England's global power declined after World War II, becoming dependent on Marshall Aid under the new world order and treaties. Following additional losses in the Suez Crisis, the British were forced to withdraw from their colonies.

During this time, domestic economic development policies led Britain to achieve the largest economy in Europe. Militarily, Britain avoided direct involvement in most operations except occasional support in the Middle East. Diplomatically, the United Kingdom retained significant influence through strong anti-Soviet policies, regaining prominence, though not to its former extent.

British power was reasserted during the Falkland Islands crisis, with continued regional activity under Margaret Thatcher's leadership. New policies and economic growth made the United Kingdom one of the strongest countries in Europe once again.

•France

— **Army: 450,000 active personnel**

— **GDP: \$602,000,000,000**

—**Population:55.570.000**

France, which emerged from World War II on the winning side but with considerable damage, transitioned to a republic for the fourth time in its history. France, benefiting from America's Marshall Aid, began domestic reconstruction plans. However, as the Algerian War of Independence that began in 1958 and the Suez Crisis that emerged during the same years concluded against France, which had sided with Israel and Britain, the 4th Republic came to an end, and the era of the 5th Republic began.

Following the crises it experienced and the independence gained by its colonies, France made a radical decision and withdrew from NATO's military wing in 1966. With this move, partially freeing itself from America's influence, efforts to strengthen the army and its inventory were initiated.

During this process, the army became one of the most powerful armies in Europe, and France became the 3rd country with the most nuclear weapons after the USSR and the United States. In most diplomatic crises, it assumed the role of mediator between the US and the USSR, and unlike other European states, it never completely severed diplomatic and commercial relations with the Soviets.

France, which is in the process of becoming a country capable of standing on its own feet without the need for America, ranks among the most powerful states in Europe.

•West Germany

— **Army: 170,000 active personnel**

— **GDP: \$780,000,000,000**

—**Population:61.700.000**

After World War II, Germany was divided first into four parts, then into the Federal Republic of Germany (West) and the German Democratic Republic (East). A significant socioeconomic disparity was observed between the two parts. West Germany, benefiting

from US support policies, was considerably more developed economically and industrially than East Germany and began receiving immigrants from East Germany and other communist-bloc or underdeveloped Eastern European countries. While this immigration revived nationalist movements, it was not as intense as in 1933 and remained quite limited. Bonn became the capital instead of West Berlin to avoid potential crises with the Soviet Union. West Berlin was blockaded due to Soviet pressure, and the blockade was partially lifted on the condition that East Germany seize 45% of supplies destined for West Berlin. While Germany eventually became the strongest economy in Europe, militarily, due to treaties and the effects of World War II, it no longer possessed the large army it once had.

The Frontline City: West Berlin was an enclave of West Germany located 100 miles inside East Germany. It served as a symbolic showcase of Western capitalism and an escape route for millions of East Germans fleeing to the West.

The Wall: To stop this mass exodus, East Germany and the Soviets built the Berlin Wall in 1961, physically dividing the city and becoming the ultimate symbol of the Cold War.

The Economic Miracle (Wirtschaftswunder): Backed by the US Marshall Plan, West Germany rebuilt its shattered industrial base to become one of the world's strongest economies.

NATO Membership: West Germany was admitted into NATO in 1955, sparking rapid rearmament to serve as the primary defense against a potential Warsaw Pact invasion.

New Diplomacy: In the late 1960s and 1970s, Chancellor Willy Brandt introduced Ostpolitik (Eastern policy). This aimed to normalize relations with East Germany and the Soviet bloc, easing Cold War tensions and establishing "two German states in one German nation."

•Italian Republic

—**Army: 260.000 active personnel**

—**GDP: \$418,347,000,000**

—**Population:56.543.000**

Italy had left behind the glory days of the late 1950s and early 1960s and had entered the “anni di piombo” (Years of Lead), a period that had been ongoing since 1969. During the anni di piombo, the Italian people were subjected to unprecedented terrorism carried out by both right-wing and left-wing terror groups. Combined with the 1973 oil crisis, widespread strikes, increasingly violent terrorist attacks, and a turbulent political landscape, the country was experiencing its first economic stagnancy since its founding.

In an effort to put an end to the strikes, new rights were granted to workers, and anti-terrorism laws came into effect that encouraged militants to become state witnesses. At the same time, Aldo Moro, who served as President of Italy from 1974 -76, supported the idea of a National Unity government to be formed with the Italian Socialist Party for a more democratic Italy. In 1976, the Italian Socialist Party, at the height of its power, accepted this proposal and launched a period that would last until 1979 and go down in Italian history as the “historical compromise.” Although terrorism continued, it was believed that the end of the “Years of Lead” was in sight.

In 1978, the kidnapping and execution of former President Aldo Moro by the far-left terrorist group the Red Brigades sent shockwaves through the Italian public.

In 1980, the Christian Democracy held their 14th congress. The death of Aldo Moro and disagreements between the two parties led the party to adopt an anti-communist program, thereby ending the coalition government with the Italian Socialist Party.

In early September 1980, Fiat announced that nearly 15,000 factory workers would be laid off. To have this decision reversed, unions and factory councils called for an indefinite strike against Fiat. In its fifth week, the strike held firm in the face of strong opposition and did not abandon its ideals. In the ninth week of the strike, bombings occurred in the squares where workers were demanding their rights. This was the largest civilian bombing incident in the history of the Italian Republic and went down in history as “Bloody November 13.” To protest this event, the unions called on all workers across Italy to join a two-month-long strike. Strikes damaged Italian economy pretty severely and made economic problems worse

In the wake of recent events, the Christian Democracy, having failed the Italian people both economically and in terms of security, saw a sharp decline in popularity. As a result, the party’s vote share dropped significantly and forced DC to create a new coalition with PSI, PRI, PSDI, and PLI . These parties have been granted more rights in coalition than ever before. For the first time in Italian history, there would be no DC member at the head of the government. Although the current government was largely composed of members of the Christian Democracy, a significant portion consisted of members of the new coalition parties, especially Italian Socialist Party, whose popularity was steadily increasing.

Today, Italy finds itself in a more complex situation than ever before in its history. The Italian government is made up of a fragile party coalition. Despite steps being taken to stop terrorism, there is no sign that it will end. Due to the chaos in Italy, the Italian Republic has experienced economic recession and unprecedented inflation for the first time since its founding. Left-wing parties have become more open to radical ideas than they used to be. With the aid provided to Southern Italy, the quality of life in the south has improved, and the number of small and medium-sized businesses has increased significantly; However, the plan to create a heavy industry in the south hasn’t achieved success. At the same time, the Italian mafia has taken advantage of this chaotic situation in Italy to gain more

influence over the Italian state than ever before. It seems quite difficult to say that Italy's future is bright, but it is certain that if Italy can solve these problems, it will be the shining star of Europe.

•**Türkiye**

— **Army: 250,000 active personnel**

— **GDP: \$143,000,000,000**

—**Population:45.997.000**

Ecevit, who became prime minister with the CHP-MSP coalition following the Cyprus Operation, resigned in order to bring about an early election. Opposition leader Süleyman Demirel also fails to form a government, and an early election is held. The CHP became the first party with 46.91% of the vote and, with 248 seats in parliament, came to power on its own. Ecevit returned to the prime ministership.

In the new period, a return is made to the constitution that preceded the 1971 Memorandum, and Atatürk's principles and reforms are added to the constitution. Opium poppy cultivation continued to be kept free, and Angora goat farming was initiated. New policies were implemented with the goal of full independence in economic and domestic affairs. ASELSAN was established, and domestic technology production for the army began. The economy came to a more stable state.

With these developments, the CHP under Ecevit's leadership won the 1979 elections once again on its own with 50.46% of the vote and 304 seats in parliament. The 3rd Ecevit government, this time, took steps in foreign policy, and efforts were initiated to repair relations with the United States. Although Turkey is a NATO member, it has begun pursuing a kind of balancing policy by establishing diplomatic contact with the USSR.

Turkey continues its existence under Atatürk's principles and reforms, the new ideas brought by Bülent Ecevit, and the 1961 Constitution. With new factories and applications, production has begun to be domesticated and nationalized, and the army has been strengthened with the help of ASELSAN and other institutions. The economy has once again become stable. Despite these developments, the left-right conflicts in the country have not decreased to the expected degree. The public nevertheless trusts Ecevit.

•Greece

— **Army: 118.000 active personel**

— **GDP: \$56,217,000,000**

—**Population:9.790.000**

Political Events: Great Left Transformation and EU Membership

This period saw two massive steps that are going to shape the next 30 years of Greek domestic and foreign politics.

European Economic Community (EEC) Membership (1st January 1981): After long negotiation Greece became the 10th member of the EEC. This membership guaranteed the democratic institutions of the country and opened a way for the country to access European funds.

PASOK's Historical Victory and "Change" (18 October 1981): The Panhellenic Socialist Movement (PASOK), led by Andreas Papandreou, won the general elections with an overwhelming majority with the slogan "Allagi" (Change). This victory meant that a radical left/socialist party came to power alone for the first time in Greek history.

Konstantin Karamanlis, The Savior of Modern Greece:

Presidential Change (1980): Prime Minister Konstantin Karamanlis, who brought the country together after the collapse of the junta in 1974, was elected President in May 1980.

PASOK's Discourse Change (1980-1981): Although Papandreou said "We will leave NATO, we will close the US bases" in the election squares, he followed a more pragmatic line after coming to power. He started negotiations to keep the US bases, but continued to allocate large budgets for the modernization of the army against Turkey.

Foundations of the Ministry of Research and Technology (1981): The Undersecretariat for Research and Technology (later transformed into the Ministry) was established in order to manage technological developments from a single source. This was the first organized step in allocating a budget for scientific research at the state level. Democritus Nuclear Research Center: Founded in the 1960s, this center began to become a regional center between 1980 and 1982, especially in the fields of radiation safety, medicine, and archaeometry (dating of archaeological findings with scientific methods).

•Japan

—Army:180,000 active personnel

—GDP:\$1,197,206,000,000

—Population:118.451.000

After losing World War II, Japan was governed by General MacArthur, who held the title of SCAP, from 1945 to 1952. MacArthur transformed Japanese society from a militaristic and authoritarian structure into a liberal one. During this period, the foundations of modern Japanese society were laid through the granting of voting rights to women, liberalization of education, legalization of labor unions, the dismantling of zaibatsu, and the drafting of a new constitution. War-torn Japan's industrial production in 1946 was only 30.7 percent of the level seen between 1934 and 1936. The United States provided over \$2 billion in support to the Japanese economy through 1951. The key factor driving the economy's recovery was the outbreak of the Korean War, which created an urgent need for war materials among the Allied forces. Positive factors such as the U.S. opening its market to Japan, the abandonment of militarism, and the Japanese work ethic launched the period known as the "Japanese economic miracle" between 1955 and 1973. By 1968, it had become the world's third-largest economy. Japan experienced a brief economic slowdown due to the oil crisis of 1973–74. As a result of the oil crisis, Japan shifted its production from oil-intensive industries toward high-tech manufacturing. Japan continues to pursue economic development and is viewed as the world's new economic superpower

The article 9 of Japanese constitution states that:

1. Japan renounces war as a sovereign right of the nation.
2. Japan will not maintain land, sea, or air forces with war potential.

By the 1950s, Japan argued that every sovereign state has the inherent right of self-defense. This interpretation led to the creation of the Japan Self-Defense Forces (JSDF), despite the constitutional restrictions.

Article 9 prohibits Japan from possessing ICBMs and aircraft carriers and bomber fleets

China-Japan Relations :

In 1972, Prime Minister Tanaka visited China to normalise relations via the signing of the Japan-China Joint Communiqué of 1972. With this treaty, Japan recognised Taiwan as part of the People's Republic of China. Since then, relations between Japan and China have normalized, and trade between the two countries has begun to grow. Japan severed diplomatic relations with Taiwan in 1972.

•Israel

— **Army: 200,000 active personnel**

— **GDP: \$27,078,000,000**

— **Population: 4,045,000**

Israel, one of the two states established in the Levant region in 1947, is the only Jewish state established in the region and in the world. It was intended that Jews and Muslims would achieve peace in the region through separate states, but Israel and the Arab countries went to war numerous times. Regardless of victory or defeat in the wars, it attempted to reach the ideal of the "Promised Land" by expanding its territories. Israel, which attempted to reach this ideal by disregarding human rights and the laws of war, invaded Palestine, Syria, and Egypt numerous times under the name of Zionism. In these wars, it invaded the Sinai Peninsula and Gaza numerous times and massacred dozens of civilians.

Israel, which increased its control over the Palestinian region in the First Arab-Israeli War, invaded Lebanon, Southern Syria, and the Sinai Peninsula during the Suez Crisis with the support of Britain and France, however after the United States and the Soviet Union jointly responded, imposed sanctions, and carried out military intervention, it was forced to withdraw from the regions it had occupied and from a portion of its control area in the Palestinian region. While this heavy defeat strengthened the ideas of Pan-Arabism and antisemitism in the Middle East, it demonstrated that Britain and France were no longer superpowers. The strengthening of Egypt's dominance over the Suez Canal and the capture of 35,000 IDF soldiers in the Sinai Peninsula pushed Israel to seek powerful allies to support it.

Israel, which began receiving active assistance by strengthening its relations with the US and NATO, received America's support (with the exception of the John F. Kennedy and partially the Lyndon B. Johnson periods). It achieved its goals, such as defeating the Arabs in the Six-Day Wars, consolidating its control over Palestine, and breaking Egyptian pressure. Israel, which subsequently became the dominant power in the region, became the state with the strongest influence abroad thanks to the diaspora and dynasties such as the Rothschilds. Through this influence, they once attacked the USS Liberty aircraft carrier and escaped without facing sanctions. To this day, they continue to engage in acts against humanity toward Palestinians and to disregard most international law.

•Portugal

— **Army: 100,000 active personnel**

— **GDP: \$40,000,000,000**

—**Population:9.911.000**

António de Oliveira Salazar, the dictator who had been governing the country since the 1930s, maintained his power throughout the 1950s and 1960s through strict censorship, a secret police organization (PIDE), and economic protectionism. Portugal remained predominantly agricultural, unindustrialized, and one of the poorest countries in Europe. A major wave of population emigration occurred; hundreds of thousands of Portuguese people emigrated to France, the United States, and Brazil in search of a better life. Portugal, which occupied a critical position due to the Atlantic Ocean islands (the Azores) during the Cold War period, became one of the founding members of NATO, established in 1949. In the early 1960s, numerous armed liberation organizations began waging wars of independence as the communist movement developed in their countries. In the region, conflicts escalating to civil war took place between armed forces organized with the support of the United States, China, and South Africa, and independence supporters. The countries that waged the most prominent wars of independence against Portugal were Angola, Mozambique, and Guinea-Bissau. As a result of these wars, the Portuguese Army, which won the independence struggle in 1974, began directing its investments predominantly toward the economy. Despite winning the war, Portugal, which lost 50,000 of its 150,000-strong army, provided financial assistance to the soldiers who participated in the war and their families. It became one of the founding members of the OECD and EFTA, established in the early 1960s, and began developing its economy in a forward-looking manner.

7. KOMINTERN/ANTI-AMERICA PACT

•USSR

— **Army: 3,800,000 personnel**

— **GDP: \$2,920,000,000,000**

—**Population:270.000.000**

— **Nuclear Warheads: Near 40.000**

After Stalin died in 1953, the new leader, Khrushchev, was elected. Minor purges take place alongside De-Stalinization policies. Under Khrushchev's leadership, some innovations were made to approach the West culturally, artistically, and socially, the innovations remained quite limited. New industrial breakthroughs were achieved to strengthen allies. These breakthroughs enabled the Warsaw Pact to strengthen politically

and economically, if only to a modest degree. Alongside all these breakthroughs, North Vietnam and North Korea were supported. However, these actions could not prevent the people of Berlin from crossing to the western side. In order to prevent the situation, West Berlin was placed under blockade. Despite West Berlin losing the logistical support of the US and its other allies, it continued to receive migration from East Berlin. As a last resort, the Soviet administration erected a massive wall across Berlin and tightened the blockade. Relations with the US, which were already tense over the situation, reached a breaking point. In negotiations held to remedy the situation, the delegations signed a new agreement and temporarily resolved the crisis. The US was forced to make significant concessions to the Soviets. It was decided that the blockade would continue in an eased form, that the Berlin Wall would remain in existence, and that the migration situation in Berlin would be reduced by 95%. The presidents of the era, Johnson and Khrushchev, personally managed the agreements. The Soviets during this period continued to support the Viet Cong in the Vietnam War, which had flared up. In 1968, Khrushchev was removed from power by a decision taken in the Kremlin and was replaced by Brezhnev. During the Brezhnev era, the Soviet Union attempted once again to put new measures into practice, and the outcome was more favorable compared to the previous attempt. These measures improved the Soviet economy, if only partially. The US withdrawal from Vietnam and the Watergate events increased the Soviets' political power. However, no special decision was taken to support new pro-Soviet minorities either. Allies, chiefly China, East Germany, and North Korea, were supported as best as possible. The economy was strengthened through newly established natural gas pipelines, and Europe began trading with the Soviets. The pipelines became a valuable diplomatic card for the Soviets. Toward the end of the 1970s, military intervention in Afghanistan was initiated. The US was forced to remain silent due to internal turmoil within the army, and this situation enabled the Soviets to advance. The Soviets are regarded as one of the world's two superpowers alongside the United States. In addition to possessing the world's largest land army and the second-largest economy, they are regarded as a serious threat to the US and Europe due to their strategic position.

•China

— **Army: 3,400,000 active personnel**

— **GDP: \$289,000,000,000**

— **Population: 1.008.175.000**

The new regime, which forced the nationalists to remain on the Island of Taiwan following the civil war, began purge operations. Approximately 7,5 million people were killed in the purge operations. Due to the inconsistency of the Chinese economy and politics, one of the greatest famines humanity has ever witnessed occurred. Nearly 80 million people died from starvation, dirty water, and diseases like pneumonia, typhoid, dysentery, and tuberculosis according to the records held during the famine.

Following the extremely bloody purges and the Great Chinese Famine, the new regime began pursuing economic policies aimed at development in the late 1960s. This development project aimed to turn Beijing, Shanghai, Nanjing, and other major centers located in the Far East into economic powerhouses. The development plan began to be implemented by establishing new factories, agricultural zones, ports, and military commissions. The rapid development yielded results, and by the mid-1970s, China became one of the ten largest economies in the world.

This plan is projected to conclude in 1985, with the goal of China becoming one of the five largest economies in the world. At this point, support for Vietnam and North Korea was continued. It is anticipated that at some point, they may even enter into a leadership crisis with the Soviets.

•Spain

— **Army: 680,000 active personnel**

— **GDP: \$124,000,000,000**

— **Population: 37.881.000**

In the civil war that began in 1936, the Falangists under Franco's leadership were defeated by the republican coalition, and Spain was reunited in 1941. However, following the turmoil in subsequent elections, war broke out again in 1944 between the republicans, communists, and Anarchists. This civil war, which was more destructive than the previous one, concluded in 1953 with the victory of the communists. The Soviets also supported the newly established regime. Spain entered a rapid reconstruction process and transitioned to a new production-based economic model. Spain's relations with the USSR began to drift away from their former state, as Spain was forced to carry out these breakthroughs without being able to receive active support. Nevertheless, Spain stands on the side of the Comintern on the international stage. In terms of political structure, a more democratic system is followed compared to the Soviets and China. Spain, with its economy and military strength, is the Soviet Union's most powerful ally in Europe.

•Poland

— **Army: 400,000**

— **GDP: \$65,500,000,000**

— **Population: 36.200.000**

One of the founding members of the Warsaw Pact. During the Soviet regime, Poland saw many economic crises and rebellions. The Poznań Rebellions in 1956 and the protests during 1970 and the 1980s showed public reaction to the Soviet Regime and economic

problems. Solidarity Syndicate was formed in 1980 at Lenin Shipyard in Gdnask and it became the first legal worker syndicate in the Eastern Bloc.

On December 13th 1981, General Jaruzelski declared martial law and Solidarity as illegal on national television. Its leaders got arrested and civil liberties got suspended.

In the 1980s Poland had the second-largest army in the Warsaw Pact after the Soviet Union. But their weapons and war machines were all Soviet made and Poland was still a communist state of the USSR.

•East Germany

— Army: 1,500,000

— GDP: \$104,000,000,000

—Population:16.700.000

East Germany, which was losing population in the face of the West's advancement, began pursuing new policies in order to prevent this migration. The number of factories was increased, and the conditions required for migration to the West were multiplied and made more difficult. Despite this, when the migration did not stop, West Berlin was placed under blockade, and the construction of the wall began. This situation led to a major crisis. Migration stopped, most families were divided, and travel between East and West Berlin became nearly impossible. A significant portion of the population was uncomfortable with this situation, but was forced to endure it due to the oppressive regime. In order to compete with West Germany, new economic policies began to be pursued in 1973. Soviet-backed factories and oil and natural gas production facilities contributed to a considerable degree of recovery in the country's economy. Today, migration between East and West Berlin remains banned, and a 45% levy is imposed by East Germany on the equipment and supplies sent to West Berlin.

•Bulgaria

—Army: 120.000

—Population: 8.900.000

—GDP:\$37,751,000,000

24th Congress of the BKP and the Peak of Zhivkov's Power (April 1981):

Congress of the Bulgarian Communist Party was held. Todor Zhivkov was re-elected as the general secretary, and immediately afterwards, in June, he took on the newly

established position of "President of the State Council", concentrating all the power in the country in one hand.

Suspicious Death of Lyudmila Zhivkova (July 1981): Lyudmila Zhivkova, Minister of Culture and Zhivkov's daughter, died suddenly at the age of 38. The death of Zhivkova, who tried to build cultural bridges with the Western world and was interested in mysticism, gave rise to rumors that she was liquidated by the USSR (KGB) and dealt a great blow to the "liberal/nationalist" wing in the party.

Celebrations of the 1300th Anniversary of the Founding of the State (Autumn 1981): The huge "1300th Anniversary of the Bulgarian State" celebrations initiated by Lyudmila Zhivkova were held. Many propaganda works were opened, including the huge monument in Shumen. This was the beginning of the communist ideology gradually replaced by strict Bulgarian nationalism.

Pope John II Jean Paul Assassination Attempt and the 'Bulgarian Connection' May (1981 - 1982): After Mehmet Ali Ağca's assassination attempt on the Pope, the allegation of the 'Bulgarian Connection' was put forward in the Western media and intelligence in 1982. Bulgarian secret service and airlines officer Sergey Antonov was arrested in Rome. This incident caused a major diplomatic crisis, making Bulgaria a "terrorism sponsor state" in the international arena.

Infrastructure of Assimilation Policies (Before the Ancestry Process): Nationalism, which escalated with the 1300th anniversary celebrations in 1980, hardened the perspective towards the Turkish and Muslim minorities in the country. The bureaucratic, ideological, and intelligence infrastructure of the mass renaming and assimilation policy (Return to Ancestry Process) to be implemented with military force in 1981 began to be shaped precisely in the party meetings and secret reports between 1979 and 1981. Cultural Closure: Lyudmila Zhivkova's death completely undermined Bulgaria's efforts to open up to the outside world. Zhivkova was replaced by more conservative and completely Moscow-oriented names. As of 1981, censorship in the world of art and literature returned to the level of the harshest periods of the Cold War.

Birth of "Pravetz" Computers (1979-1981): The beginning of Bulgarian computer technology dates back to these years. Engineers led by Ivan Marangozov produced the country's first personal computers by reverse engineering the Apple II architecture.

1980 - IMKO-1: Bulgaria's first microcomputer was successfully produced in the laboratory.

1981 - IMKO-2: This model was later exhibited, achieved great success, and was ready for mass production. was brought.

1981 – Pravetz 82: Mass production started in the famous Pravetz factory, based on IMKO-2. Bulgaria became an IT center, supplying computers to the entire Eastern Bloc and its schools.

Kozloduy Nuclear Power Plant Expansion (1979-1981): Nuclear energy investments were vital for Bulgaria's scientific and industrial independence.

Between 1980 and 1982, the construction of the Soviet-designed VVER-440 type nuclear reactors (Units 3 and 4) was completed and fully put into operation. This move massively increased the country's electricity generation capacity, making Bulgaria one of the largest energy exporters in the Balkans.

"Shield-82" Giant Military Exercise (1982): In the autumn of 1981, the Bulgarian territory hosted the "Shield-82" (Shield-82) exercise, one of the largest and most comprehensive military exercises in the history of the Cold War. The exercise simulated an operation against NATO (especially the border with Turkey and Greece) in a possible Third World War scenario.

The Bulgarian People's Army, Soviet forces, and others Together with the members of the pact, carried out a massive show of force in which nuclear, chemical, and conventional weapons were used simultaneously. This caused the military alertness on the Turkish border to reach its highest level.

Land Forces: The period when T-72s, one of the most modern tanks of the period, began to be intensively entered into the army inventory, and the personnel were trained with these tanks.

Air Force: Bulgarian Air Defense introduced new MiG-23 fighter planes in order to increase deterrence against NATO aircraft. Missile Systems: Military personnel training on tactical ballistic missile systems (Scud and OTR-21 Tochka) capable of targeting NATO bases was maximized in these years.

•Yugoslavia

—**Military: 180 000 active personnel, 450 000 reservists, and over 1 million Territorial Defense personnel**

—**Population:22.646.000**

—**GDP: \$75.000.000.000**

Josip Broz Tito emerged from World War II as the leader of communist Yugoslavia and became the central figure holding together the country's many ethnic, religious, and regional groups. In 1948 Yugoslavia became the first communist state to openly break with the Soviet Union. Stalin accused Yugoslav leaders of deviating from Soviet doctrine and withdrew Soviet advisers. The Cominform expelled Yugoslavia and called for Tito's overthrow. In response, Tito resisted Soviet pressure and pursued an independent path to socialism.

Tito died on 4 May 1980. Leadership passed to the collective presidency in a peaceful transition but the federation lost its strongest unifying figure. Following the death of Tito in 1980 Yugoslavia entered a period of political uncertainty while the collective presidency has preserved national unity, economic difficulties, rising nationalism, and disagreements between the republics continue to threaten internal stability. Despite these challenges, Yugoslavia remains one of the most influential members of the Non-Aligned Movement and seeks to maintain independence from both NATO and the Warsaw Pact.

Yugoslavia developed a unique system of workers' self-management after the split with Moscow. Beginning in 1950, enterprises were managed through workers' councils rather than direct state ownership. Although the Communist Party retained ultimate authority the system granted greater autonomy to local enterprises and distinguished Yugoslavia from the Soviet model.

Yugoslavia consisted of six republics—Bosnia and Herzegovina, Croatia, Macedonia, Montenegro, Serbia, and Slovenia, and two autonomous provinces Kosovo and Vojvodina. Tito's 1974 constitution decentralized authority significantly granting republics veto powers and increasing provincial autonomy. By the early 1980s, Yugoslavia faced rising unemployment, inflation, and foreign debt. The government had to work with the Soviets, but their help wasn't enough.

During the Tito era heavy foreign borrowing contributed to a severe debt crisis after 1980. Inflation became one of Yugoslavia's most serious economic problems, even reaching crisis levels by the end of the decade. Even though they worked with the USSR, the Yugoslav government also worked closely with the IMF while implementing stabilization and reform programs intended to control inflation and restructure the economy.

Yugoslavia was an active member of the United Nations and participated extensively in international organizations and Yugoslavia's relationship with the USSR improved after Stalin's death. However, Yugoslavia never rejoined the Soviet bloc and maintained its independent foreign policy. After 1948 the country received Western aid and military assistance but preserved strategic independence.

Non-Aligned Movement :Yugoslavia was a founding member of the Non-Aligned Movement and one of its most influential leaders. Tito worked alongside leaders such as Jawaharlal Nehru and Gamal Abdel Nasser to establish the movement. They stand beside the Komintern just to fight against the Western imperialism.

•Egypt

—Military: 367.00

—Population:42.800.000

—GDP: \$26.000.000.000

In 1952, as a result of the Free Officers Movement, a republic was proclaimed in Egypt, and Gamal Abdel Nasser became Egypt's new president. Under Nasser's leadership, Egypt progressed within the framework of nationalizing the economy, national independence, and anti-Zionism. Nasser aimed to unite Arabs under a single roof against American imperialism. Following the 1956 Suez Crisis, he gained immense power through the victory achieved and the support of the international community. Leveraging this power, a United Arab Kingdom, which would be governed as a constitutional monarchy and consisted of the unification of Iraq, Syria, and Jordan, was established in 1959. Established under the premiership of Abd al-Karim Qasim, the country received the direct support of Egypt.

By 1967, due to escalating tensions, the State of Israel attacked the Arab Republic. In the following days of the war, Israel occupied the Sinai Peninsula. The war concluded with the Sinai Peninsula being ceded to Israel. By 1973, the Arab Republic, alongside the United Arab Federation, declared war on Israel in order to reclaim its lost territories. The war ended with a partial victory for the Arab Republic. While the western part of Sinai was reclaimed by the Arab Republic, the eastern section remained under Israeli control. On October 25, 1973, a 10-year ceasefire was signed between the two states. During the ceasefire, through the intervention of the United Nations, a peace corridor was established between the two countries along the borders determined by the truce.

Following all these developments, the country suffered a heavy defeat in the **Six-Day War**. Israel established an unofficial administration in Jordan and a part of southern Syria, which it annexed shortly after. Turkey also intervened for the rights of the Turkmen in Syria, and turmoil began within the Arab League. This turmoil escalated further with Nasser's sudden death in 1970. With Anwar Sadat coming to power, a new era began in Egypt, and Egypt signed several agreements with the US. This process made a significant contribution to Egypt's economy but disturbed certain factions. Anwar Sadat was assassinated in 1979, and the former Chief of the General Staff, Mohamed Fawzi, took his place by capitalizing on the power vacuum. Although Egypt is once again pursuing anti-US policies, it avoids implementing them as aggressively as before and is engaged in a leadership struggle with Saddam's Iraq over the Arab League.

•Iraq

—Military: 450.000

—Population:23.560.000

—GDP: \$58.180.000.000

Since its independence in 1932, Iraq has experienced periods of instability and conflict, as well as periods of significant economic and military growth. Formerly a part of the Ottoman Empire, the country came under British mandate rule following World War I and became an independent kingdom in 1932. Before the coup of 1958, King Faisal II sought to unite the Hashamite Kingdoms of Iraq and Jordan under the banner of the **Hashamite Federation**. Faisal didn't survive the revolution but his dream did. Abd al-Karim Qasim rebranded it into the Arab Federal Republic and quickly integrated Jordan's military wing into a singular army. Qasim, positioned this union as a rival to Nasser's United Arab Republic.

In 1961 when Syria revolted and broke away from Egypt, Qasim funded Syrian separatists and marched federal troops to the border. Turkey and Israel followed suit, protecting their borders and forming temporary occupation zones in Idlib and Çobanbey and parts of West Bank and Golan Heights respectively. After the civil war Baghdad effectively absorbed a fragile Syria under the guise of "Protecting Arab Unity". Following this unification, the official name of the state was changed to the "United Arab Federation" By 1962, Qasim's new goal was his biggest yet to take advantage of the ongoing civil war in Lebanon and driving Israel back from the West Bank. At the end of the third Arab-Israeli war, Lebanon remained a sovereign country and Israel officially annexed the Golan Heights and West Bank including Jerusalem. By 1963 everyone wanted Qasim gone and on February 8, 1963 (during Ramadan), the underground Ba'ath Party and nationalist army officers launched a brutally violent coup. They bombed Qasim's headquarters at the Ministry of Defense, seized the national radio station, put him through a mock trial, and executed him by firing squad. They broadcasted video footage of his riddled corpse on national television. For weeks, Ba'athists went house-to-house executing, torturing, and imprisoning thousands of people. On November 18, 1963 Field Marshal Abdul Salam Arif used the regular army to turn on them, kicked the Ba'ath Party out of the government, and established a military dictatorship. In later years, the administration passed from Abd al-Salam Arif to his brother, Abd al-Rahman Arif. Iraq was politically fractured, economically stagnant, and still humiliated by the war of 1962. On the morning of July 17, 1968, Ba'athist officers and various military insiders successfully stormed the presidential palace and took control of the government. After the coup Ahmed Hassan al-Bakr became the president of the Arab Federal Republic. In the 1973 Yom Kippur War occurred between two sides. Federation and Egypt against Israel. At the end of the war, Egypt pushed back Israel through the Sinai Desert while changes were unimportant between Iraq and Israel. During these years, the tension experienced between Iraq and Iran due to border disputes would turn into war.

In 1976 President Ahmet Hasan el-Bekir left most of his power in the hands of Saddam then later in 1979 he left all of his power in the hands of Saddam.

In September 1980 Iran-Iraq war started. In the first couple of months Iraq advanced rapidly through Iran but after the first month's advancement stopped and Iran regained all territory it had lost by 1982.

The war still continues.

•**Socialist Republic of Romania**

— **Army: 150,000**

— **Population: 22,477,000**

— **GDP: \$55,300,000,000**

During the Cold War, Romania was a communist state. Its goods, oil, and agricultural products were funneled to the USSR. The Soviets secretly mined Uranium in Bihor County using political prisoners. Uranium mined from there directly funded the Soviet atomic bomb project.

In the 1960s, Romanian leadership began moving away from Moscow's shadow, shifting toward a nationalistic version of communism under Gheorghe Gheorghiu-Dej and his successor, Nicolae Ceaușescu.

Soviet Troop Withdrawal: Following negotiations, Romania became the only Warsaw Pact country to successfully demand the removal of all Soviet troops from its territory by 1958, remaining free of a permanent Soviet military presence for the rest of the Cold War.

Foreign Policy Autonomy: Romania maintained neutrality in the Sino-Soviet split, maintained diplomatic ties with Israel, and was the first Warsaw Pact nation to open diplomatic relations with West Germany in 1967.

Economic Crisis and Dictatorship (1970s-80s): While being independent in foreign policy, Ceaușescu's dictatorship began to be more oppressive and eccentric in the Eastern Bloc. Because of heavily borrowed debts, the period of austerity began. Secret policies were used to impose heavier censorship around the country.

8. Map

